Jun Hyun Ji

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics, University of Pittsburgh — 2021 – May 2027 (expected)

M.A. in Economics, Sogang University — 2020

B.A. in Economics, Sogang University — 2016

RESEARCH FIELDS

Microeconomic Theory, Decision Theory, Strategic communication, Behavioral

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Preference over Choices"

Bringing about the same outcome can earn praise, blame, or neither, depending on what was given up and at what cost. I develop a decision-theoretic model of these judgments, which underlie how people reward and punish one another. From an observer's ranking of another person's choices (outcome–menu pairs), I separate her valuation of outcomes from her praise or blame for choosing them. She compares his actual choice with the one she expects and credits him for the sacrifice she expects him to make. These expectations depend on what she thinks ought to be chosen and what she believes he values. Hence, the more difficult she believes doing the right thing is for him, the more she praises success and the less she blames failure. The model explains why observers who agree on what ought to be chosen can disagree about praise and blame. By deriving these judgments from an observer's preferences, the model clarifies the restrictions built into familiar measures of kindness in theories of reciprocity and accommodates judgments those measures exclude.

WORKING PAPERS

"Consistency and Strategic Disclosure in Model-based Persuasion"

Persuasion often works by supplying a model through which observed data are interpreted. I study persuasion when the receiver, beyond requiring that the model fit the observed signals well, demands that it be consistent, treating the signals as independent and identical draws rather than reading meaning into patterns. I characterize the persuasion cost of consistency in terms of the entropy of the empirical distribution of the signals, so that the more the signals differ from one another, the weaker the persuasive power. I then consider a sender who privately observes the signals and discloses only part of them at the time of persuasion, before the receiver sees the rest. When the signals are not all alike, the sender can avoid the cost of consistency entirely and fully manipulate the receiver's beliefs. When they are all identical, disclosing more of them makes the signals easier to fit, but consistency limits how much this added evidence can work in the sender's favor. The optimal disclosure is either a single signal or all signals; a single signal is best only when the receiver initially reads the signal as sufficiently bad news.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Preference over Indifference"

Can indifference itself be desirable? People may value another person's indifference as open-mindedness or dislike it as a lack of commitment. I develop an axiomatic model of how people evaluate others' choices when decision-makers can declare indifference among several options. I characterize a "no preference for indifference" condition under which declaring indifference does not by itself contribute to the value of choices. I discuss deviations from this condition.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, University of Pittsburgh

Game Theory Principles (ECON 0200) — Summer 2024, 2025

Teaching evaluation score: 4.65/5 (2024), 4.69/5 (2025).

Teaching Assistant (delivered class), University of Pittsburgh

Microeconomic Theory I (First-Year Ph.D.) — Fall 2022, Fall 2025

Teaching evaluation score: 4.68/5 (2022), 5.00/5 (2025). (Instructor: Jetlir Duraj & Luca Rigotti)

Introduction to Microeconomic Theory — Spring 2023, Spring 2024

Teaching evaluation score: 4.40/5 (2023), 4.34/5 (2024). (Instructor: Margarita Zabelina & Lester Lusher)

Mathematical Methods of Economic Analysis (First-Year Ph.D.) — Fall 2023

Teaching evaluation score: 4.84/5. (Instructor: Jetlir Duraj)

Teaching Assistant, Sogang University

Mathematical Economics; Labor Economics; Econometrics; Principle of Economics I

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS & HONORS

Art & Science Graduate Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh (2022, 2023, 2025, 2026)

Andrew Mellon Pre-doctoral Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh (2024)

Tamara Horowitz Memorial Fund Award, Department of Philosophy, University of Pittsburgh (2023)

Arts & Sciences Summer Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh (2023)

Reuben E. Slesinger Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh (2021, awarded to the most promising entering Ph.D. student)

Nam Duck-woo Economic Research Institute Scholarship, Sogang University (2020)

SEMINAR & CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026	Midwest Economic Theory Conference, Toronto Metropolitan University
	Microeconomic Theory Brownbag Seminar, University of Pittsburgh
	37th Stony Brook International Conference on Game Theory, Stony Brook University
	6th Durham Economic Theory Conference, Durham University
	PETCO (Pennsylvania Economic Theory Conference) poster session, Pennsylvania State University
	2nd Workshop on Choice & Welfare, Queen Mary University of London
2025	Microeconomic Theory Brownbag Seminar, University of Pittsburgh
	BSE Summer Forum 2025 (Choice & Decision Workshop)
	2024 Asian School in Economic Theory, Econometric Society, NYU Abu Dhabi

2024	Microeconomic Theory Brownbag Seminar, University of Pittsburgh
	PETCO (Pennsylvania Economic Theory Conference) poster session, Pennsylvania State University
	Pittsburgh Economics Medley Conference poster session, University of Pittsburgh
2023	Microeconomic Theory Brownbag Seminar, University of Pittsburgh
2018–2019	Applied Theory Research Center Seminar, Sogang University

ACADEMIC SERVICE

2023–2024	Mentor, Economics Graduate Student Peer Mentoring Program, University of Pittsburgh
2019	Seminar Organizer, Applied Theory Research Center Seminar, Sogang University
2018–2019	Study Mentor, Undergraduate Economics Study Center, Sogang University

PRIOR EMPLOYMENT

2015–2017	Data Analyst, Corporate Strategic Planning Team, Nuskin Korea

PERSONAL

Citizenship	Republic of Korea (US visa: F-1 Student)
Language	Korean (native), English (fluent)
Military Service	Sergeant, Republic of Korea Army (2009 – 2011)

REFERENCES

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